

SNIPPETS

Electronics to cost more from March

All the major consumer electronic giants, such as LG, Godrej & Boyce, Videocon and Whirlpool, are planning to increase the price of refrigerators, washing machines, air-conditioners and flat-panel displays by up to 5 per cent from March this year. This will make up for the increasing prices of raw materials like steel, plastic and copper, and increased VAT on consumer durables.

India's security system needs urgent upgrade

Almost half of India's defence equipment is obsolete and needs urgent upgrade. Only 15 per cent is state-of-the-art, as per the first comprehensive report on the country's defence sector prepared by global consultancy firm KPMG and the Confederation of Indian Industry.

Micron, Origin to develop solar PV technology

Micron Technology, a memory giant, has formed a 50:50 joint venture with Australia-based Origin Energy, to develop solar PV technology. The partnership is expected to bring innovation in PV technology by bringing together semiconductor manufacturing expertise of Micron and Origin's experience in the solar field.

Samsung to manufacture 80 per cent of mobiles overseas

Samsung Electronics will manufacture over 80 per cent of its mobile phones in overseas plants in 2010. Its facility in Tianjin, China, will produce the most at 82.72 million units, followed by Huizhou, China (73.26 million), Gumi (48.36 million), Vietnam (34.15 million), Brazil (13.95 million), Shenzhen, China (8.97 million) and India (8.27 million).

IBM tops US patent list

IBM received 4914 US patents in 2009, topping the list of the world's most inventive companies for the 17th consecutive year. Its 2009 patent total nearly quadrupled HP's and exceeded the combined issuances of Microsoft, HP, Oracle, Apple, Accenture and Google. IBM was followed by Samsung and Microsoft with 3611 and 2906 US patents, respectively.

Microsoft and HP eye Tablet PC

Tablet PCs are creating a lot of buzz, with all major players planning to launch one this year. After Apple, Microsoft and HP are the latest companies to eye tablets that bridge the gap between laptops and smartphones.

Tata buys BT's Mosaic business

Tata Communications has reached an agreement to acquire BT Group's (BT) Mosaic business, which offers an on-demand digital media management platform that manages content and workflow from production to distribution across collaborative market ecosystems.

Panasonic to double India sales

Capitalising on India's rapidly growing demand for cars, Panasonic aims to more than double its sales in the country to \$1 billion in the fiscal year ending March 2013. The company, which currently sells home electronics in India, is in talks with local auto manufacturers to provide car audio-related equipment and liquid crystal display panels. It is likely to start providing car-related items as early as 2011.

LG to boost handset sales by 20 per cent

LG is planning to sell 140 million mobile phones this year. The manufacturer had sold 117 million handsets last year, beating its target of 100 million, to claim about 10 per cent of the global market. It claims that Google's Android operating system will not only beef up its smartphone line-up but also increase the handset sales by 20 per cent.

application model, advance cloud computing by speeding application implementation, and eliminate complexities of IT management and automate existing manual processes to lower the overall costs.

Consumer electronics revenue set to grow in USA

As the economy begins its slow recovery from the recession, the consumer electronics industry will lead the way with popular product categories poised for growth in 2010 in the US. It will generate more than \$165 billion in US shipment revenues this year—a slight increase from 2009—according to the Consumer Electronics Association (CEA), USA.

Wireless handsets are expected to become the primary revenue driver. Smartphones will continue to lead the way, with more than 52 million unit sales in 2010.

Sales of computers are also expected to be a bright spot as the category continues to be driven by the popularity of netbooks. Netbook sales more than doubled in 2009. In 2010, more than 30 million notebooks will be sold in the US.

Blu-ray players will continue to grow after a strong 2009. Blu-ray unit sales rose 155 per cent in 2009 with more than seven million units sold, generating more than \$1 billion in revenue. The trend will continue in 2010, with unit sales projected to top 11.5 million.

The television market has been one of the primary revenue drivers for the past several years as consumers made the transition to high-definition, flat-panel sets. Unit sales will climb to more than 37 million in 2010 but price drops will cause display revenue to decline slightly to \$22 billion. Innovation in TV displays, such as 3D, Internet connectivity and OLED technology, will continue to grow and help maintain revenue in the display category. CEA projects sales of more than four million 3D television sets in 2010.